

Impossible Project I-1

Many attempts to reinvent a marvellous technology from the past, have only ended up with a half-baked attempt. The Impossible Project's very first camera, an instant Polaroid with digital frills, is far from that. In fact, it seems to have poised itself beautifully in the fine line of balance between the analogue instant cameras and wireless controls.

The Impossible Project I-1 has a flash ring surrounding the lens module, and uses a reverse-engineered custom Impossible type 600 instant film, inspired by the original Polaroid type 600 film that was discontinued eight years ago. On the outside, it looks extremely simple and organised. On the inside, it packs in a number of digital tricks. For instance, the 'advanced ring flash' can adjust its intensity based on the ambience and the focus distance of the subject. It also gets a rechargeable battery pack that you can charge via an USB cable, and the highlight of the pack is the companion app, which you can pair to the camera via Bluetooth and get full manual controls including shutter speed, aperture, flash strength, and even remotely controlling the camera shutter.

The package that the I-1 presents is incredibly beautiful, with a classic body accompanied by smart interiors. It becomes yet another product that highlights the beauty of the past, like the



Lomography Daguerreotype Achromat 64mm lens. The camera will premiere on May 10, and be priced at \$300. It will be sold online, posing a direct competition to the simpler lineup of Fujifilm Instax cameras.



Orah 4i

Orah 4i by VideoStitch is the first company to introduce live streaming content in virtual reality. The Orah 4i is not just another 360-degree camera, it can actually record and stream Full HD content directly to headsets like the HTC Vive and Oculus Rift.

This is a major breakthrough in the field of hardware supporting the rise of VR. We are already witnessing a rising number of apps and games that support virtual reality, engaging users within the arena of an event, be it a game, or a music concert. The mechanism is quite simple - Orah uses four, custom-built cameras with four individual microphones, to record audio and video from all directions. The aluminium-clad camera module is accompanied by a 'stitching box' - a Linux-based computer that stitches all the four feeds together to give you a unified feed of 4K resolution virtual reality video. Adding to this, the output format of the video is the same as the format supported by Facebook and YouTube, the major players promoting live video broadcasting on the Internet, to the masses.

The Orah 4i went up for preorders on April 6, and is available for \$1,795 (₹1,19,250) for a limited period, and peaks at an MSRP of \$3,595 (₹2,38,800). Sure, it is expensive for now. But then again, this is the first of a kind that will certainly see the world of imaging devices evolve in future.